



## Pink-Bellied Side-Necked Turtle Fact Sheet

**Common Name:** Pink-bellied side-necked turtle, red-bellied short-necked turtle or  
Jardine River turtle

**Scientific Name:** *Emydura subglobosa*

**Wild Status:** Least Concern

**Habitat:** In lagoons, lakes, ponds, streams and rivers

**Country:** Papua New Guinea and Australia

**Shelter:** Hiding in plants, logs,

**Life Span:** 50 years

**Size:** 5 to 10 inches

### Details

The pink-bellied side-necked turtle is found in Papua New Guinea and Australia, in streams, wetlands, lakes, lowland swamps, rivers and ponds. They are a freshwater turtle and they spend their life in water. Pink-bellied side-necked turtles have a yellow stripe that runs from the tip of their nose through their eyes and into the iris. They have olive-colored heads. They have two yellow whiskers on their chin. Young pink-bellied side-necked turtles plastron color will go from bright red to pink as they get older. The females have a larger [carapace](#) and shorter tails. The pink-bellied side-necked turtles mate year round but peaks in spring and fall. The males communicate with the females by a series of signaling postures, eye blinking and head bobbing. Only the female pink-bellied side-necked turtles leave the water in order to deposit eggs in the soil of the [forest](#) floor, often near the base of trees or in the sandy soil of freshwater swamps. They lay about 4 to 11 eggs at a time, 7 on average and can produce 2 to 4 clutches a year. Hatchlings have to find their way back to freshwater by themselves. The pink-bellied side-necked turtle when threatened can bite and snap. The pink-bellied side-necked

turtle is able to communicate using a wide range of vocalizations that humans can not hear. The pink-bellied side-necked turtle diet consists mainly on algae, sponges, macrophytes, aquatic macro-invertebrates, insects that fall into the water, and periphyton. They are omnivorous. The [pink-bellied side-necked turtle](#) predators are red foxes, domestic cats, water rats, goannas and crows who prey on nests. In some areas crocodiles, marine turtles, tiger sharks and humans are the main predators.

### **Cool Facts**

- The pink-bellied side-necked turtle pulls their necks in [sideways](#) instead of straight like other turtles.
- Their diet consists mainly of crustaceans, [mollusks](#), fish, and aquatic insects.
- The pink-bellied side-necked turtle has beautiful bright colors giving it the name "painted terrapin."
- The pink-bellied side-necked [turtle](#) hatchlings are about 4 inches long.
- These turtles have barbels on their chin, which they uses to help forage for live prey along the bottom of streams and ponds.
- The pink-bellied side-necked turtle is a freshwater turtle.

### **Taxonomic Breakdown**

**Kingdom:** Animalia

**Phylum:** Chordata

**Class:** Reptilia

**Order:** Testudines

**Suborder:** Pleurodira

**Family:** Chelidae

**Genus:** Emydura

**Species:** Emydura

### **Conservation & Helping**

The pink-bellied side-necked turtle is listed as least concern but some feel they should have some pre-emptive conservation in place due to those wanting turtle meat and turtle products. Another possible threat is the increase in anthropogenic threats.

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